

GREGOR MENDEL

czech geneticist
1822–1884



Gregor Mendel grew up on a farm in the Austrian Empire (now the Czech Republic), but after studying philosophy and physics in college, he decided not to become a farmer himself. Instead, he joined a monastery to train as a monk. This gave him the chance to study more science and mathematics, too. At the monastery, he worked hard teaching school students and ran experiments in the monastery gardens. Eventually he became the abbot—the person who runs the whole monastery—and he had no spare time for his plants, but he had already made an important discovery.

Secrets of life

Gregor was interested in trying to understand how certain characteristics of plants passed from parents to their offspring. He decided to investigate, using his science and math skills.

Characteristics



Gregor studied pea plants, which were easy to grow and had characteristics that were easy to tell apart, such as their seed color.

